



## GRADUATE DIPLOMA IN MANAGEMENT

**January 2026**

**GDM 601: Leadership and Management in a Digital Economy**

**(Batch 88)**

Case Study (Pre-seen)

|                  |                                             |
|------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| Qualification    | ATHE Level 6 Graduate Diploma in Management |
| Issued Date      | 31 January 2026                             |
| Module Tutor     | Sanduni Wickramarachchi <i>BSc</i>          |
| Exam Date & Time | 7 February 2026 - 9.00 am – 12.10 pm        |

### **Learning Outcomes:**

By the end of this unit students will be able to:

- LO1:** Understand the approaches to leadership and management to meet organisational objectives
- LO2:** Apply theories of management and leadership to support teams in achieving goals

## **JEFF WEINER: EXCELLENCE THROUGH PURPOSE AND COMPASSION**

Jeff Weiner served as the CEO of LinkedIn from late 2008 to 2020, after which he transitioned to the role of Executive Chairman. His leadership excellence has been widely recognised through multiple awards, including Fortune's World's Greatest Leaders, Glassdoor's Highest-Rated CEOs, and diversity leadership recognitions by Comparably.

For LinkedIn, Weiner defined the vision of the company as "creating economic opportunity for every professional," which indicates his ability to articulate a compelling vision. This vision functioned as the "true north" of the company and provided employees with a higher purpose beyond quarterly targets, motivating them to align individual work with long-term organisational outcomes. This vision guided LinkedIn toward product innovations such as LinkedIn Career Advice, which supports individuals lacking professional networks. Weiner insisted on continuous communication and exemplified organisational values through coaching and strategy development. As CEO, he practised humility, ethical behaviour, and self-reflection, emphasising compassion as a core leadership value. He consistently encouraged integrity by aligning his personal behavior with LinkedIn's values, such as "Members First" and "Relationships Matter."

He believed in managing people with empathy and compassion to build trust within the organisation. Through this approach, he aimed to improve both the speed and quality of decision-making. This ability of Weiner transformed employees' decision-making processes, enabling them to make decisions in minutes or hours rather than months, thereby demonstrating how a compassionate culture can become a competitive advantage. Weiner also encouraged leaders to support and develop employees individually. He advised managers to be honest yet supportive when addressing performance gaps, framing improvement conversations with encouragement and clear development plans. This reinforced a culture in which employees felt valued and understood rather than judged or sidelined. Furthermore, his leadership approach ensured that employees were "set up for success" rather than blamed for shortcomings.

Weiner also structured meetings to promote strategic focus and positive engagement. Weekly executive meetings began with each leader sharing personal and professional wins. This infused positivity among employees and reinforced connection before discussing tactical or strategic issues. He institutionalised reflection time in his calendar and promoted thoughtful decision-making instead of reactive management. He also supported the use of Objectives and Key Results (OKRs), encouraging teams to set stretch goals and rethink conventional approaches to achieving performance targets. Weiner's encouragement on leaders and employees to challenge assumptions and think long-term has guided LinkedIn towards success.

## LEARNING OUTCOMES AND ASSESSMENT CRITERIA

| Learning Outcomes                                                                        | Pass                                                                                                      | Merit                                                                                                                      | Distinction                                                                                                                                       |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Understand the approaches to leadership and management to meet organisational objectives | 1.1 Discuss different approaches to leadership and management to meet organisational objectives           | 1M1 Analyse different leadership and management performance and competences to meet organisation objectives                | 1D1 Recommend suitable leadership and management approaches in different organisational context to meet organisation objectives and achieve goals |
| 2. Apply theories of management and leadership to support teams in achieving goals       | 2.1 Apply a range of management and leadership theories to creating teams for given organisation contexts | 2M1 Compare the impact of different theories of management and leadership, and their impact in given organisation contexts |                                                                                                                                                   |

~ End of Paper ~